



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kenai Classical School
School Website: <https://kenaiclassical.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Kenai Classical School (Kenai, AK) presents a clearly Christian, classical-education orientation with a pronounced emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent sense of truth, goodness, and beauty. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation of character in service of faith, with explicit statements about glorifying God, Christ-centered pedagogy, and a Paideia-inspired aim to cultivate virtue and reason. The curriculum includes liberal-arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a humanities-focused approach, history throughout the program, and a formal emphasis on rhetoric in upper levels. There is a structured diploma path with multi-year requirements in humanities, sciences, languages (including Latin), and logic, reinforcing a classical backbone. Public materials stress parent partnership and community engagement as central to the educational mission.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- Strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: the school emphasizes Christian formation, virtue, and a theologically grounded view of education, explicitly describing its mission to glorify God and to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty.
- Purpose and Goal aligned with classical aims: formation of virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, rather than employment-focused outcomes.
- Curriculum anchored in classical liberal arts and languages, with grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, and emphasis on original sources in humanities. Some elements akin to “Great Books” framing are suggested through “reading original sources” and classical humanities emphasis, though explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not overtly stated in public materials.
- Pedagogy shows classical elements (logic and rhetoric in upper levels) but lacks explicit, broad references to Socratic seminars across the full program in the public materials. Some contemplative/restful pedagogy is not heavily documented in public pages; emphasis appears on course structure and rhetoric.
- Faculty presence is signaled through a dedicated Faculty page and public materials about the school’s teachers; public signals emphasize virtue, mentorship, and partnership with parents.
- Parents and Community: strong emphasis on partnership with parents, parental formation, accessibility for visits, and community involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission and identity framed as Christian, Christ-centered, and God-glorifying.
- Explicit language about nurturing virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty in students’ formation.
- Use of Paideia-inspired language (“Christian Paideia”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: Christ-centered, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Paideia, glorify God.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials. (No explicit secular-relativist signals observed in the accessible content.)

Why this rating



- The school explicitly grounds education in Christian theology and virtue, with a stated aim to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty as real transcendentals. The language aligns with the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the classical rubric. This category meets the classical standard.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or workforce-readiness.
- Explicit reference to liberal-arts orientation and Paideia framing as a telos of education.
- Recurrent themes of truth, goodness, and beauty as real ends of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, Paideia, liberal education.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present (no strong emphasis on job-readiness or workforce-prep signals in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The material consistently positions education as formation toward human excellence and the good, with an explicit classical-philosophical telos. This aligns with CLASSICAL for Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Clear liberal-arts backbone (grammar, logic, rhetoric) appears in the public materials, with explicit course credits and structure (e.g., 4 years humanities, 4 years science, 4 years foreign language with Latin, 2 years logic, 4 years math).
- History is studied throughout the curriculum (elementary through upper school) and is presented as chronological/geographical study rather than a simple “social studies” label.
- Reading original sources and developing rhetorical skills are highlighted as part of humanities formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, Latin, reading/original sources, humanities, paideia, liberal education.
- Negative keywords found: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in public materials; no direct reference to “Great Books” or an established Great Conversation program in the public site content.

Why this rating

- The curriculum shows a robust classical foundation (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; languages; humanities) but lacks explicit public articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation and some classic pedagogy signals. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Upper School includes rhetoric/composition and logic, indicating engagement with classical modalities beyond mere content delivery.
- The curriculum shows emphasis on humanities, languages, and formal logic, which aligns with traditional classical pedagogy in the upper grades.
- Some explicit classical practices (Socratic seminars, chanting, memory work, and deep-reasoning discussions) are noted in the knowledge lexicon as indicators of classical pedagogy, but public site materials do not consistently confirm these practices across the entire program. The site highlights

discussions and rhetoric at higher levels, but does not consistently document Socratic seminars or extensive memory work publicly.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: logic, rhetoric, rhetoric/composition, discussion, Paideia (via the language of classical pedagogy and rhetoric).
- Negative keywords signaled by the lexicon (not necessarily found on the site): explicit, broad acceptance of experiential learning-only approaches or exclusive project-based pedagogy; not clearly evidenced on public pages. The absence of explicit “Socratic seminars” in public pages is noted as a potential gap.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates key classical pedagogy components (grammar/logic/rhetoric and upper-level emphasis on rhetoric and logic) but lacks consistent, explicit public documentation of several canonical classical practices (notably Socratic seminars across the full program and commemorative memory-work signals). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site includes a dedicated “Our Faculty & Staff” page, signaling focus on the teacher as central to the school’s mission. This aligns with the classical notion of the teacher as mentor and living embodiment of the curriculum.
- Mission statements describe teachers and administrators as core to forming character and virtue; the public materials imply a collaborative, virtuous-teacher model and a portrait of teacher-student partnerships.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: living curriculum (implied by emphasis on virtue, mentorship, and faculty centrality), teachers as mentors, portrait of teacher expectations (through the Faculty page).
- Negative keywords: none explicit in public content.

Why this rating

- The explicit existence of a faculty page and the emphasis on teacher-mentors and living curriculum align with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with parents and parental formation, including co-teaching language and parent involvement in the educational process. Public statements frame parents as partners/co-teachers.
- The site promotes open engagement, with opportunities for parent involvement, updates, and visits.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus/parent involvement.
- Negative keywords: consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement are not evident in the public materials.

Why this rating

- Clear, explicit emphasis on parent partnership and community formation aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

With four categories CLASSICAL and two SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the overall assessment lands in CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school seeks to transition from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Categories 3 and 4 to CLASSICAL across the board, it could explicitly codify and publicly communicate:
- Great Books / Great Conversation: Add explicit language about Great Books and Great Conversation in the curriculum descriptions and mission statements, and align reading lists with canonical Great Books with a formal plan for integration across grades. This would address the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in public materials.
- Socratic Pedagogy: Publicly document and implement Socratic seminars or Socratic-inspired seminars across the upper grades, with faculty training and a defined schedule. This would complete the missing explicit Socratic aspects of pedagogy.
- Contemplative Scholé: Include and publicly describe contemplative, rest-oriented days (Scholé) or restfulness as a regular element of the pedagogical calendar, with clear rationale and examples from the curriculum.
- Liturgical/Communal Practices: Consider articulating liturgical or communal practices (even if limited to certain celebrations, chapel-like activities, or family-liturgy alignment) to meet the liturgy/worship dimension of the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.
- Publicly emphasize the living-curriculum language for Faculty: strengthen the articulation of teachers as mentors and the living curriculum with explicit statements and examples of teacher-student mentorship, professional development in classical pedagogy, and the portrait of teacher/students.

ABSTRACT

Kenai Classical School AK 99669 presents a CLASSICAL profile grounded in Christian formation, virtue, and the liberal-arts tradition. The school foregrounds God-centered formation, truth, goodness, and beauty as real ideals, with a mission to glorify God through a rigorous, Christ-centered, classical education that cultivates wisdom and virtue. The curriculum displays a robust classical backbone (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; Latin; humanities) and a mission to form character and intellect in tandem, with explicit parent partnership and community engagement.

Category-by-category, Kenai Classical exhibits CLASSICAL strengths in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Curriculum and Pedagogy categories show strong classical signals (grammar/logic/rhetoric and history within the program; rhetoric and logic in upper levels) but lack explicit public documentation of some canonical classical practices (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing and prevalent Socratic pedagogy across the entire curriculum). Consequently, these two categories are rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL due to a majority of the categories clearly meeting classical criteria and the overall alignment of mission, curriculum design, and community engagement with classical education principles.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL — explicit Christian grounding, virtue formation, and Paideia language.
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL — formation of virtue and wisdom as primary telos.
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL — solid grammar/logic/rhetoric and history emphasis; lacks explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in public materials.

- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL — upper-level emphasis on logic/rhetoric; lack of explicit Socratic/seminar documentation across the program.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL — presence of a faculty-focused structure and living-curriculum signals.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL — explicit partnership and parental formation.

Note: The sources cited above come from the Kenai Classical School public-facing pages and the classical lexicon used in the knowledge base, which provides the canonical keyword framework for evaluating classical education. The Kenai content includes mission statements, course descriptions, and program structure that anchor these category assessments.

ABSTRACT (Final Section)

Kenai Classical School AK 99669 demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation with a strong Christian formation focus. The school foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent sense of truth, goodness, and beauty, anchored in a Christ-centered pedagogy. The curriculum shows a solid classical backbone (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; Latin) and formal language around a humanities-driven program, supplemented by a multi-year diploma framework. Pedagogical practices emphasize rhetoric and logic in upper grades and a humanities-forward approach, though explicit documentation of Socratic methods and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation programs in public materials is lacking. Faculty and parental partnerships are clearly emphasized, reinforcing the classical ecosystem. Overall, Kenai Classical School stands as CLASSICAL with some areas—primarily explicit Great Books/Great Conversation articulation and broader Socratic pedagogy documentation—where it could strengthen to achieve full classical status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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